



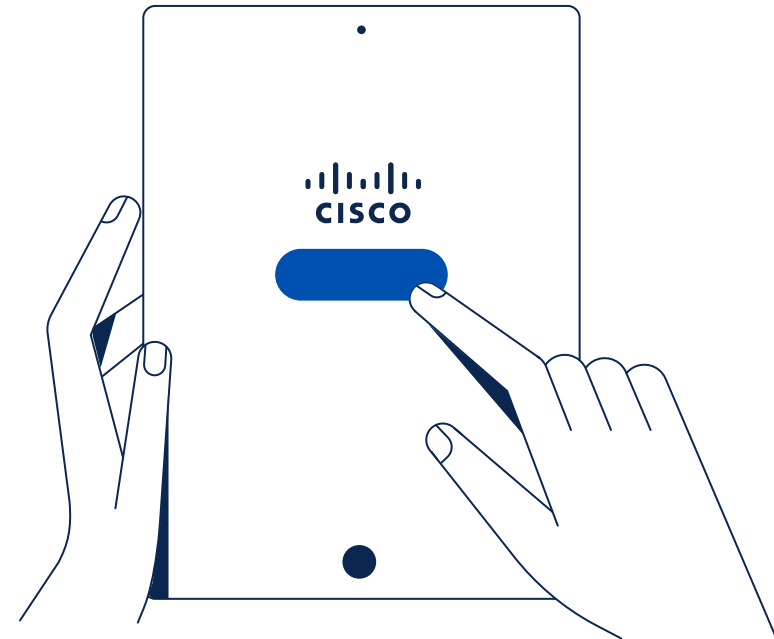
# Cisco Live 2026 Las Vegas

AI Image Generation for Technical Sessions

# Ethics and compliance

- Ensure you already own the appropriate [copyright license](#) for any third-party copyrighted images, music, or characters used (do not use any non-Cisco trademarks or labels).\*
- No written consent is required for conversations between internal Cisco teams about customers (use cases, sales wins, etc.), as long as there are no actual customers participating or speaking in the video.

\* Legal requirement



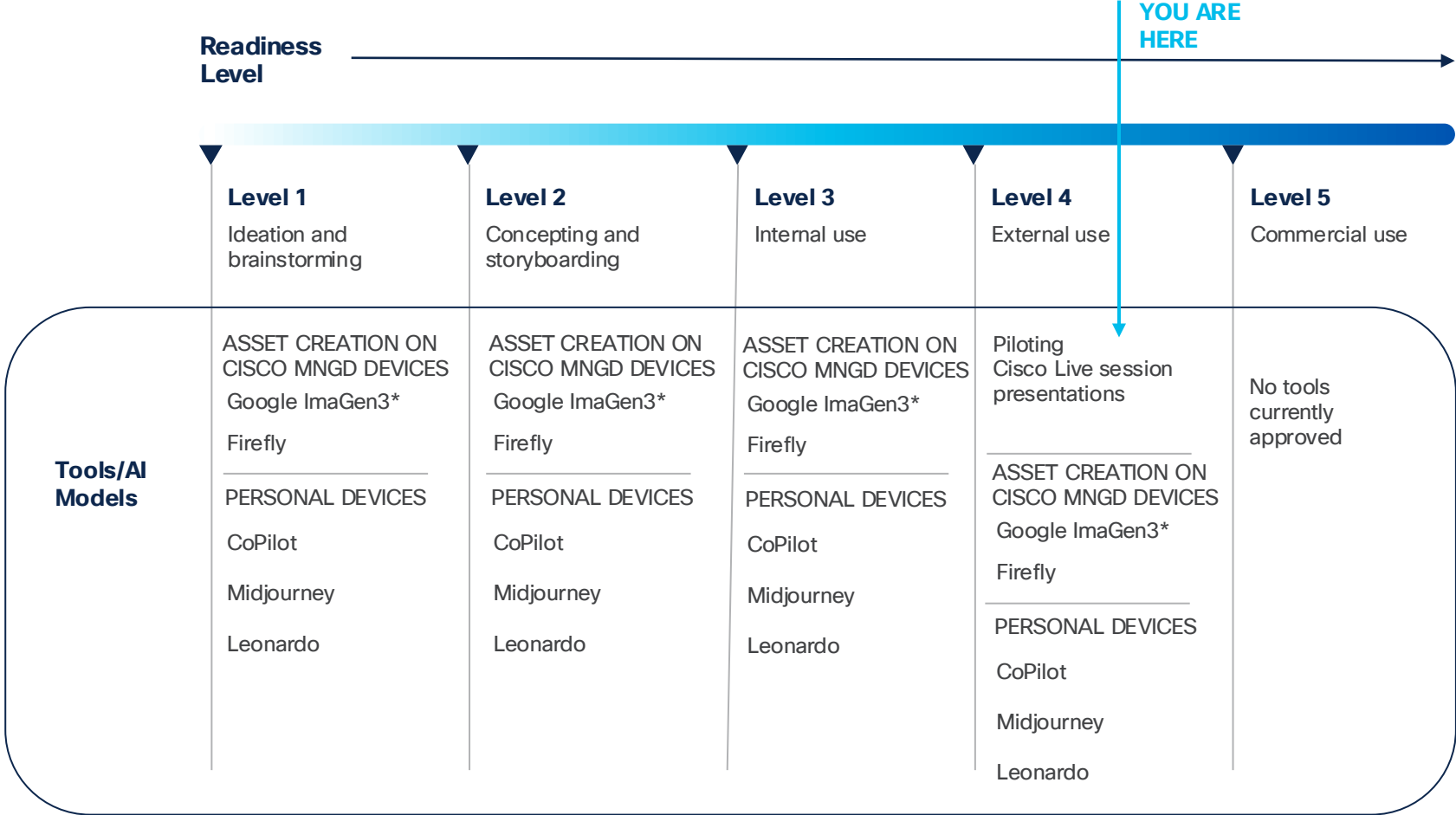
Ethics and legal resources: [Cisco Legal >](#)

# AI Image Generation Standards & Guidelines

# AI image readiness spectrum

(Photography and illustration)

The following is a list of tools that can be used for image generation for Cisco Live presentations. **This is a pilot program and does not constitute the approval for the use of generative AI at-large across Cisco.**



# General GAI guidelines

Only use Cisco Public data when creating images using GAI, while adhering to the guidelines in this document. Cisco Public data may include synthetic (artificially generated) or real-world data that is non-sensitive and non-confidential. For more information, visit Cisco's [Generative Artificial Intelligence \(GAI\) Policy](#).

No assets from Brand Exchange should be used as a seed image for GAI image generation.

Do not use GAI to create images of actual, identifiable people or specific individuals, alive or dead. This reduces the risk of inadvertently producing deepfakes (synthetic media where a person's likeness is digitally altered or replaced) or violating various rights to publicity or persona.\* This approach helps maintain trust and ensures that our brand is not perceived as engaging in or endorsing such practices.

It is crucial to prioritize keeping Cisco's [Responsible AI Principles, Framework](#), and the [GAI Policy](#) forefront while exploring new GAI features. As GAI image generation tooling continues to develop and advance, this guide may be updated accordingly. For any questions or feedback, please contact the [Incubation, Data, and AI Strategy Team](#).

\* Legal Requirement

# Creation and editing of photos using GAI

“[AI slop](#)” refers to low-quality media made using GAI and is associated with filler content that prioritizes speed and quantity over substance and quality. These are concepts we do not want the Cisco brand to be associated with. Telltale signs that an image is AI-generated include anomalies such as extra fingers, garbled letters or symbols, and unnatural lighting. While AI slop may exhibit these features, other common problems include generic and repetitive content, unrealistic or fantastical elements, and poor composition and focus.

## Using GAI to edit existing creative

### Permitted

- Content-aware patch, move, scale, crop
- Generative expand
- Generative fill
- Skin retouching
- De-noising a grainy image
- Enlarging an image

### Not permitted

- Changing people’s physical appearances
- Changing too much of an image that it becomes a fantastical scenario
- [Altering the Cisco logo in any way \(use of third-party logos / trademarks not permitted\)\\*](#)
- Removing any watermarks

## Using GAI to make new creative

### Permitted

- Generation of images for: sharing ideas, sharing abstract concepts and storytelling for Cisco Live session presentations

### Not permitted

- Generation of typography or logos
- Generating images of Cisco products or technology
- [Generating images based on known third-party copyrighted material such as superheroes, characters, and recognizable persons, living or dead\\*](#)

\*Content generated entirely by AI must be marked as **“AI-Generated” and the prompts used to create the images must be retained by the presenter**

\* [Legal Requirement](#)

# Prompting best practices

- Use clear, descriptive language
- Follow a basic formula of subject + style + format
- Be specific about the details
  - Subject: Include information about what they are doing, what is in the background, where are they located, what is the lighting, what is the desired mood, where the subject is in the frame
  - Style: Set the tone by describing the style (e.g. photo-realistic, painting, sketch)
  - Format: Consider what orientation, size, aspect ratio, and output is desired
  - Add any photographic elements such as lens length, desired f-stop
- Avoid inadvertently generating output that is copyrighted or trademark-protected by a third party\*
  - Examples of prompts to avoid:
    - Show me Google's logo for their new product
    - Produce an image of Andy Warhol's soup cans that uses Cisco's color palette
    - Create an image with Bluey standing in front of a Cisco building
    - Create an image of Superman in a data center, on a Webex meeting
    - Produce an image of Elvis Presley holding a sign that says INNOVATION

\* Legal Requirement

# Use of logo & Cisco typeface in AI image gen tools

Our logo and other trademarks are valuable intellectual property, and misuse can weaken their legal protection. Additionally, artistic license with logos should be kept to a minimum and strategically driven.

GAI tools struggle to accurately render logos. Do not use GAI to create Cisco logos or other trademarks.

Logos and text should be added after an image is generated using appropriate design, editing and layout tools.



## Typography

### CiscoSans TT

CiscoSans is our typeface. But our typography is more than words on a page—use it to bring the big idea to life.

We have a weight for every occasion. These are the ones we use most often.

Aa

CiscoSans ExtraLight  
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ  
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

CiscoSans Light  
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ  
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

CiscoSans Regular  
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ  
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

CiscoSans Medium  
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ  
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

CiscoSans Bold  
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ  
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

CiscoSans font packages are available for download from  
[Cisco Brand Exchange](#).

 Brand Guidelines





# Images of people

## Diversity and inclusivity

Represent individuals of various ages, genders, ethnicities, and abilities.

## Realistic features

Ensure accurate skin tones and features.

## Natural expressions

Use candid, relaxed expressions and body language.

## Anatomical accuracy

Verify accurate anatomy, particularly hands and limbs.

## Seamless integration

Maintain realistic lighting, depth, and perspective.

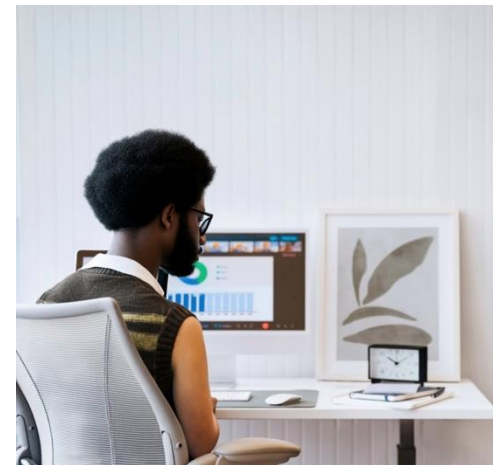
## Error inspection

Check for GAI errors like random objects, merged accessories, or blurred features.

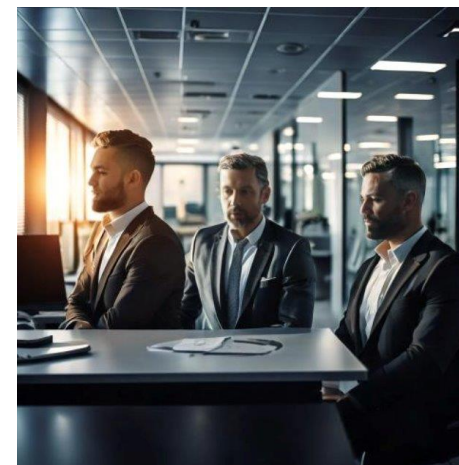
## Approved GAI style



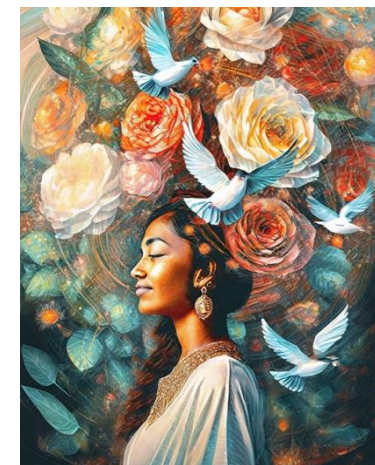
## Unapproved GAI images



Not approved due to:  
mismatched skin tones



Not approved due to:  
unrealistic scene



Not approved due to:  
not following brand  
visual standards

# Images of people using technology

## Realistic device placement

Position devices naturally in hands or on surfaces with proper perspective.

## Proportion accuracy

Ensure devices are proportionate to human anatomy.

## Natural interactions

Depict candid and realistic use of technology.

## Lighting consistency

Avoid unnatural lighting and shadows.

## Accurate UI

Display realistic interfaces that align with Cisco products and applications.

## Workplace realism

Avoid unrealistic integrations in workplace environments.

## Approved GAI style



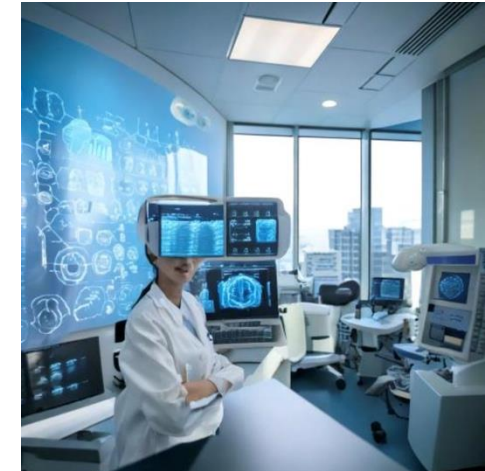
## Unapproved GAI images



Not approved due to:  
blurry, inaccurate anatomy



Not approved due to:  
inaccurate anatomy



Not approved due to:  
unrealistic integrations in  
workplace environment



# People at work

## Avoid stock photo aesthetics

Steer clear of forced handshakes and unnatural smiles.

## Show genuine collaboration

Highlight authentic moments of teamwork, problem-solving, and innovation, preferably in small groups.

## Anatomical accuracy

Verify accurate depictions of hands, arms, and object interactions.

## Meaningful content

Ensure screens, documents, and presentations display realistic and relevant information.

## Realistic environments

Avoid unrealistic or distorted office settings.

## Diverse work settings

Include remote, office, and hybrid work environments for variety.

## Approved GAI style



## Unapproved GAI images



Not approved due to:  
unrealistic setting, stock  
photo aesthetics



Not approved due to:  
inaccurate depiction of hands



Not approved due to:  
inaccurate depiction of  
hands

# Places and things

## Accurate environments

Avoid geographical or architectural inaccuracies and ensure realistic depictions of real-world locations.

## Realism in visuals

Maintain correct lighting, perspective, and spatial relationships.

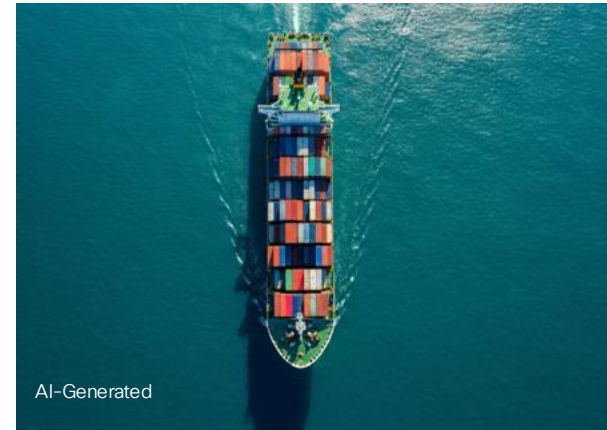
## Balanced office aesthetics

Show business environments that are modern yet approachable.

## Functional and realistic objects

Ensure objects are correctly designed and feature realistic materials and textures.

## Approved GAI style



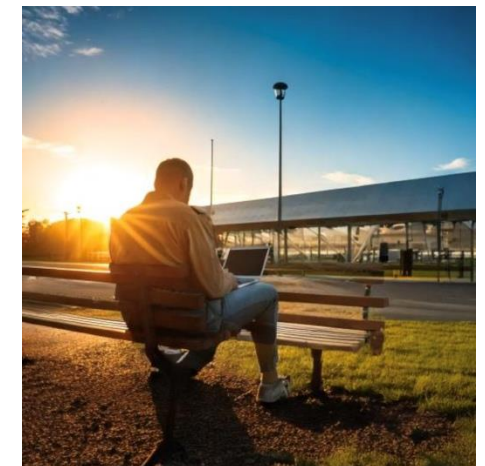
## Unapproved GAI images



Not approved due to:  
incorrect object geometry



Not approved due to:  
unrealistic scene



Not approved due to:  
incorrect object geometry

# Product

There are currently no approved image generation tools for generating images of Cisco products.

## No GAI seed images

Cisco products must not be used as seed images in image generation tools.

## Use appropriate graphics and retouching tools

Use Photoshop or similar software to add Cisco products to any GAI images. GAI-created environments, such as offices or workspaces, should be accurately represented and realistic.

## No GAI for Cisco product

Do not use GAI to depict any Cisco products, as results may be unrealistic or inaccurate.

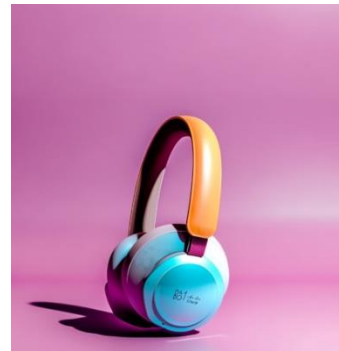
## No GAI for Cisco environments

Do not use GAI to create any images that depict products and technology, such as rendering a data center, as it may be inaccurate.

# Approved GAI style

Generating images of Cisco products is prohibited.

# Unapproved GAI images



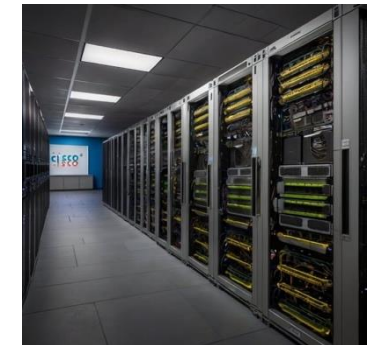
⊘ Not approved due to:  
inaccurate colors



⊘ Not approved due to:  
inaccurate scale



⊘ Not approved due to:  
incorrect colors, shadows



⊘ Not approved due to:  
incorrect environment



# Representing the concept of AI

Images representing AI should focus on the positive aspects of AI and the outcomes AI achieve, not fake futuristic scenarios.

## Avoid cliché

Avoid images that represent humanoid robots, cyborgs, the overuse of artificial blue color palettes and glows

## Avoid scary or negative futuristic images

Images should focus on positive use of AI and avoid dark menacing representation of people, places and things

## Focus on outcomes

Focus on the outcomes that AI achieves by representing real scenarios.

Consider using abstract concepts to representing ideas like productivity, automation, security, personalization



Not approved due to:  
dark, menacing



Not approved due to:  
humanoid robot



Not approved due to:  
unrealistic scenario



Not approved due to:  
cyborg depicted

# Illustration

# Illustrations

## No GAI for Cisco illustrations

At this time, we do not have a suitable program to replicate our illustration style.

## No GAI prompting

Do not prompt GAI to create illustrations.

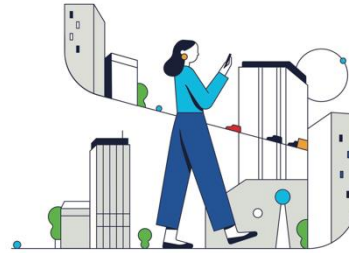
## Use GAI for brainstorming

GAI can be used to create illustrations for brainstorming and storyboarding.

## Avoid mascots and cartoons

Cisco Brand is not a brand that utilizes superheroes, mascots or cartoons. The use of GAI to create such images should be avoided.

## Approved style



## Approved illustration style NOT created by AI

All approved illustrations must be created using traditional design techniques and not modified by or created using GAI

## Unapproved AI images



Not approved due to:  
superhero depiction



Not approved due to:  
cartoon, mascot



Not approved due to:  
incorrect style



# Latest Additions – 24 July 2025

# Video / Music / Voiceover (as of 25 July 2025)

We are currently piloting the use of two Cisco-approved tools for video generation as listed below. All content created must be in alignment with the Brand AI guidelines found in this deck.

## Using GAI for video

### Permitted

- Generation of videos for: sharing ideas, sharing abstract concepts and storytelling for [insert event] breakout session presentations
- Video generated by Adobe Firefly
- Video generated by Google Veo

### Not permitted

- Use of unapproved tools
- Changing people's physical appearances
- Changing too much of an image that it becomes a fantastical scenario
- [Altering the Cisco logo in any way \(use of third-party logos / trademarks not permitted\)\\*](#)
- Removing any watermarks

\*Content created must be in alignment with the AI guidelines in this deck and **prompts use to create the video must be retained by the presenter**

## Using GAI for voiceover

### Permitted

- Voiceover generated by ElevenLabs

### Not permitted

- Use of unapproved tools
- [Generating images based on known third-party copyrighted material such as superheroes, characters, and recognizable persons, living or dead\\*](#)

## Using GAI for music

**There are currently no tools approved for music generation.**

\*Music is complex and involves a lot of potential for copyright infringement. Please do not attempt to generate any music using AI.

\* Legal Requirement

